

STATEMENT OF RESEARCH

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I am a PhD candidate in Organizational Behavior at Cornell University's ILR School. My research examines the social dynamics of entrepreneurship, work, and gender, with a focus on how digital platforms and emerging technologies reshape opportunities and outcomes. Specifically, I investigate new forms of work enabled by digital technology, the origins and consequences of gendered patterns in digital entrepreneurship, and the social dynamics driving these patterns.

Dissertation and Job Market Paper

My dissertation examines digital entrepreneurship from multiple angles, applying management, entrepreneurship, and sociological theory. Across three chapters, I investigate how algorithms shape gendered entrepreneurial evaluation outcomes on digital platforms, how entrepreneurial identity shapes digital founders' behaviors and outcomes, and how content creation within the creator economy constitutes a distinct new form of digital venture creation.

My job market paper, "Approval Without Amplification: Gender and Entrepreneurial Visibility on Algorithmically Mediated Platforms," asks whether the evaluation-driven mechanism behind women's entrepreneurial disadvantage operates the same way when audience reception passes through algorithmic amplification before it becomes visibility. Research on gender in entrepreneurship often explains women's disadvantage through unfavorable evaluation: women receive less positive assessments and, as a result, fewer resources. On algorithmically mediated platforms, however, algorithms are part of the evaluation system, sitting between audience reception and visibility, a critical monetizable resource central to platform entrepreneurship. Studying a random sample of 9,232 established U.S. YouTube creator entrepreneurs, I combine channel metrics, creator characteristics, more than six million audience comments, and visual, written, and spoken content measures to examine channel views, a key metric of visibility that shapes monetization and venture success. Women creators receive about 33% fewer views than men creators. Production volume differences account for roughly a third of the raw gap, but the remaining 22% gap is not explained by the content women produce, and audiences do not appear to like women's content less: women receive more engagement, show no comparable controlled subscriber gap, and receive more positive, less profane comments.

The visibility disadvantage instead reflects what I term a "negative arousal bonus": positivity is associated with fewer views, negativity and profanity with more views, and women's softer comment sections, a pattern consistent with benevolent sexism, are less likely to attract the visibility-feeding engagement signals that algorithmic recommendation systems promote. This comment-language

channel accounts for most of the remaining gap, and robustness analyses rule out reverse ordering as well as differences in self-promotion, commenter gender composition, and audience backlash against women. The findings show that favorable, lower-intensity gendered reception can coexist with disadvantage when engagement signals feed visibility, suggesting that lowering barriers to entry may shift inequality from access to amplification rather than remove it, and they argue for integrating algorithmic intermediaries into our theories of how gendered evaluation becomes consequential for entrepreneurial outcomes. The manuscript draft is complete, I am editing it for journal submission, and the paper has been accepted for presentation at the 2026 Academy of Management meeting.

In another dissertation chapter, currently under review at *Administrative Science Quarterly*, I draw on 61 qualitative interviews with digital-era entrepreneurs to identify a novel “Individualist” founder type who organizes the venture around the founder’s own idealized self rather than an external market opportunity. I offer a process model of entrepreneurial self-enclosure: digital tools, cultural scripts of self-actualization, and post-organizational precarity together make it both possible and culturally encouraged to found a venture without necessarily first verifying that anyone will pay, with weak market signals interpreted as the price of freedom. Finally, a third dissertation chapter conceptualizes content creation within the creator economy as a distinct new form of digital venture creation: one in which the creator’s persona is often the product, an algorithm stands between the creator and the audience, and near-zero entry costs permit founding and scaling without traditional infrastructure. I develop a three-phase account of how these ventures are founded and scaled, from establishing a persona and discovering an audience, to monetizing audience support, to converting persona equity into firm equity, with a full draft planned for fall 2026.

Broader Research Program

In other collaborative projects, I examine how evaluative institutions reshape macro organizational behavior and entrepreneurship. In one project, currently under review at *Organization Science*, I examine how gender ideology and institutionally-promoted separate-spheres cultural beliefs can shape the decline of women’s entrepreneurship. In another, I study how government rhetoric & mandates trigger heterogeneous regulatory compliance among employers, with political ideology moderating the timing of firms’ responses. In a third, I investigate how corporate responsibility ratings catalyze shifts in board gender diversity norms. Across these projects (and others), the common thread is a focus on how social dynamics, whether evaluative, ideological, or institutional, shape experiences and success in work settings.

Future Research Agenda

My future research program continues to explore the questions at the center of my dissertation: how do digital platforms and social forces shape who participates in entrepreneurship, and with what consequences for various social groups? While my job market paper samples creators at a few

discrete points in time, for future work I am building a larger longitudinal panel dataset of YouTube creators, using multiple sampling methodologies and ongoing daily collection as an affiliate of YouTube's Researcher Program, extending the observation window both backward and forward in time and enabling cohort analyses and causal inference methods. As this dataset matures, it will allow me to examine questions about how platform policy changes, new technologies like AI, and shifting audience behaviors differentially affect creators by social category over time. Beyond digital platforms, I am exploring how family and school structures shape entrepreneurial entry, examining whether spousal overwork pushes individuals into self-employment as a flexibility strategy and how gendered patterns of overwork may contribute to differences in who enters entrepreneurship and in what form.

My research questions are grounded in firsthand experience: before entering academia, I founded and sold a digital marketing asset company, experiencing the platform dynamics and gendered market conditions that I now study empirically. My research is relevant to scholars interested in the social dimensions of entrepreneurship, technology, innovation, labor markets, and organizational theory.